(iv) Development of 250 competency based modules for each individual vocational course;

(v) Establishment of a vocational education cell within the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE);

(vi) Assistance to 150 reputed NGOs to run short-duration innovative vocational education programmes; and

(vii) Pilot programme under the National Vocational Education Qualifications Framework (NVEQF) in Class IX in Haryana and West Bengal.

Saakshar Bharat/Adult Education

The National Literacy Mission, recast as *Saakshar Bharat* (SB) launched by the Prime Minister on September 8, 2009, reflects the enhanced focus on female literacy. The literacy rate according to the 2001 census was 64.83 per cent, improving to 74.04 per cent in 2011.

The literacy rate improved sharply among females as compared to males. While the literacy rate for males rose by 6.9 per cent from 75.26 per cent to 82.14 per cent, it increased by 11.8 per cent for females from 53.67 per cent to 65.46 per cent. The target of the Eleventh Five Year Plan is to achieve 80 per cent literacy. With just one year to go for the Twelfth Five Year Plan, 74 per cent literacy has been achieved. Literacy levels remain uneven across states, districts, social groups, and minorities. Since the Mission has been envisaged as a people's programme, stakeholders, especially at grassroots level, have due say and role in its planning and implementation. The decentralised model of the Mission provides PRIs a pivotal role in implementation of the programme at district level.

Annual Status of Education Report (ASER) 2012

The *ASER-2012* was released on *Jnauary 17, 2013* – we may have a look in two parts:

I. Positives Changes or Status Quo

Rising enrollment: In 2012, 96.5 per cent of all 6-14 year olds in rural India are enrolled in schools. This is the fourth consecutive year that enrollment levels have been 96 per cent or more. In 2006, in eight major